

Guide to Cover Letter Writing

A cover letter is a tailored marketing document designed to showcase your relevant education, experience, and skills.

- Think of a cover letter as your opportunity to introduce yourself, your resume, your skills and experiences, and your interest in a job to a potential employer.
- Your cover letter will demonstrate your interest and qualifications for a job. You should rarely send a resume without one.
- Your cover letter and resume are often a company's first impression of you.
- Many employers not only use cover letters to develop an understanding of why you are interested in and qualified for the position but also to assess your writing abilities and attention to detail (nothing says "I am not detail oriented" typos and spelling mistakes).
- While it is important not to restate everything on your resume, you should highlight and briefly expand upon those elements of your resume which you think particularly qualify you for the position.
- Tailor the letter for the specific job and specific company—a generic letter will not do!

Your letter should be formal and brief, about three to four paragraphs, and no more than a page.

- It should concisely describe your qualifications and interest in the job and company.
- If your resume is in 10- or 11-point font, your cover letter should be in 11-point font. If providing a hard copy, it should be printed on the same quality and color paper as your resume.
- It should be signed using the SAME name that you use on your resume, your email address, and any other documents.
- When emailing a cover letter, either paste it into the body of the email or attach it to an email with your resume.
- If attaching both documents, write a brief but formal message explaining that you are attaching documents in the application for "x" position.

Your cover letter should explain how you learned about the position, why you are qualified, and why you are interested.

To write a strong cover letter, follow these three steps:

- **Research the employer**
Conduct research on the organization through the company website, resources such as the Firsthand guides and Glassdoor.com (available through the Shevet Glaubach Center for Career Strategy and Professional Development website at www.yu.edu/sgc), and industry contacts. Use the research to help demonstrate why you are a strong fit with the employer and why you are interested in working for that specific organization.
- **Analyze the job description**
Look for the duties and qualifications of the job and design your cover letter to match these as much as you can. If the job listing is brief, draw from your research of similar jobs to infer what skills might be required.
- **Analyze your background**
Think about your background in relation to the job duties and qualifications. Ask yourself, "What have I done that is similar to the duties of this job or that requires similar skills?" Consider courses, class projects, previous jobs, internships, volunteer activities, and athletics.



Sample Internship Cover Letter

The following are guidelines for structuring the letter

Research

It is worth some research time to find the specific contact's name. If you cannot find a name, consider using: Hiring Manager, Human Resources Representative, Search Committee. Be sure to include Contact's Name, Title, Company Name, Address, City, State, and Zip Code.

Opening Paragraph

Your opening paragraph should explain what position you are applying for and how you heard of the position. Discuss why you are interested in the position, the company, and the industry. If you are being referred by a specific person, write that in this paragraph, including his/ her full name and title.

Body

Your middle paragraph is the substance of your cover letter. Give details about your background and strengths that show the reader why you would be an excellent candidate for this position. Select specific items from your resume that you would like to emphasize. Be specific about the type of position you are interested in and why you feel you are qualified for the position. Discuss related experience and extracurricular activities. This is your opportunity to demonstrate to the employer that you should get an interview. This paragraph can be split into two paragraphs by themes.

Closing Paragraph

In your closing paragraph, suggest a specific type of follow-up. Reiterate your interest in the position and emphasize your qualifications—do not simply restate things you have already said. Make sure you convey a positive attitude.

Don't:

- Focus only on what YOU will get out of it. Emphasize what you will bring THEM.
- Draw attention to any weaknesses.
- Rehash your resume; instead, elaborate.
- Have any errors? Proofread thoroughly.
- Use general statements ("Good communication skills," "Great leader," "Best candidate for the job") without backing it up with specific examples.

DO NOT COPY and DO NOT CUT AND PASTE SENTENCES!

This format and general idea can be used for any industry or any job!

119 E. 29th Street
New York, NY 10016
310-709-3009
anita.levy@mail.yu.edu

September 7, 2022

Lily Smith
Employment Manager
Prudential
1 Industry Plaza
New York, NY 10033

Dear Lily Smith,

I am sending you my resume upon the suggestion of Freddie Mae, who works in the benefits division of Prudential. Your company stands out as an industry leader in providing clients with financial solutions and security, and I am eager to contribute to such important work. Like Prudential, I, too, value integrity, quality customer service, and trust. I am interested in the Actuarial Associate- Model Risk Management position. I believe my educational and work background and my successful completion of the first actuarial exam, Exam P, would make me a strong candidate.

As a Math major, minoring in both Computer Science and Economics, I have developed excellent analytical and quantitative reasoning skills and knowledge of programming languages, all of which are valuable to any actuary. Through my coursework, I have produced both independent works in my programming and math assignments and proven my ability to work equally well within a team setting through group projects in economics. My GPA of 3.5 attests to my dedication to excellence. In addition, as a valuable member of my college's varsity tennis team, I have achieved excellence in singles and doubles matches to help my team advance.

Additionally, I have complemented my academics with internships applying what I have learned to practical work problems. In the summer of 2020 and 2021, I interned at StockCross Financial Services, where I built upon my technical and communication skills as I updated client information on various computer programs, including Excel, and provided clients with stock quotes and options. Earlier at the Orthodox Union, I strengthened my analytical skills as I needed to assess the KPIs of the organization's teen outreach programs and recommend improvements based on my analysis. The position also enhanced my technical skills as I took the initiative to fix data entry errors within their system.

Through my education, athletics, and internships, I have managed to succeed in a demanding schedule due to my strong work ethic, ability to set priorities, and adaptability. Attached you will find my resume, which highlights in greater detail my accomplishments. After reviewing it, I hope you will grant me an interview to show you how I might add value to your company while learning more about the Model Risk Management team's work.

I appreciate your consideration and look forward to hearing from you soon.

Sincerely,

Mark Jacobs



Full Time Job - Cover Letter Sample

DO NOT COPY and DO NOT CUT AND PASTE SENTENCES!
This format and general idea can be used for any industry or any job!

Keira Eisenberg

412 Church Avenue, Cedarhurst, NY 11516
hayrton@mail.yu.edu | (516) 123-4567

Dear Ms. Nunn:

I am writing to apply for the Volunteer and Outreach Coordinator position at Help Children Succeed as posted on Yeshiva University's Career Center's Career Link website. My communication, volunteer management, and analytical skills make me well suited for this position.

The mission of Help Children Succeed to provide health, education, and social services to at-risk adolescents is a great fit with my passion to pursue a career in the human services field. My experience volunteering with organizations such as Women's League Community Residence has allowed me to get my feet wet in this field. This experience has helped me gain more awareness of social services and ways to help reach at-risk individuals. I am eager to work for Help Children Succeed, and I feel my skills would be a valuable contribution.

My time recruiting and supervising volunteers as a Resident Advisor (RA) directly applies to the Volunteer Coordinator Position. As an RA, I coordinated over a dozen volunteers in my hall to host a 5K walk that raised \$14,000 to support breast cancer awareness. This event required close communication with volunteers, vendors, and the host site.

My strong work ethic is evident in my job at Dante's Coffee, where I voluntarily created an employee training manual that is now utilized by management with all new hires. Additionally, I kept extensive records of transactions utilizing Microsoft Office, implemented customer surveys, and updated the company website. My well-developed analytical skills and ability to work independently would make me a good candidate to maintain all human resources aspects of the volunteer program.

I welcome the opportunity to elaborate on how I could make a substantial contribution to Help Children Succeed and have attached a copy of my resume for your review. Please feel free to contact me by phone at 917-555-5555 or by email at keira.eisenberg@mail.yu.edu. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

SIGNATURE

Keira Eisenberg



Emailed - Cover Letter Sample

USE THIS FORMAT IF PASTING COVER LETTER IN THE BODY OF AN EMAIL

(If attaching a Word document, use the formal letter format)

SAMPLE OUTREACH FOR RESEARCH OPPORTUNITY DO NOT COPY & DO NOT CUT AND PASTE SENTENCES!

Dear Broadcast Associate Hiring Manager,

It is with great excitement that I submit my application for the Broadcast Associate role at CBS News. As a network, CBS's reach, impact, and accolades are incredibly impressive, serving as a testament to the hard work and dedication of personnel and company leadership. I am prepared to contribute to the success of the #1 primetime network as a Broadcast Associate with the experience and skills I bring.

My candidacy for the Broadcast Associate role is based on skills developed across communications, client relations, and management. My knowledge and competence in media relations comes from firsthand experience with external communications as a National Director of Enrollment & Graduate Relations, where I consistently performed as the school's principal contact. As a Vice President of Branding and Strategic Management, social media became a forte where engagement and communications converged to drive successful efforts to re-brand and revitalize information delivery to important constituents. My passion is to ensure constituents are served, brands are marketed, and messages are sent with the audience in mind, translating directly to the responsibilities of a Broadcast Associate.

Where I do not possess direct hands-on experience in journalism and news media, I reconcile my interpersonal, organizational, and team-oriented skills and a strong willingness to learn and perform. Such skills afforded me the opportunity to develop and author a memorandum of understanding between international constituents as a Graduate Research Assistant at North Carolina Central University. In this role and others, I effectively responded to external and self-imposed pressure to perform with resilience and results. Success in such roles occurred due to my ability to pivot in response to changing needs and uphold the responsibilities I held on to teams I was a part of. As a Broadcast Associate, my motivation would be to learn the team environment while relying on my transferable skills to perform for the team's greater success.

I would like to reiterate my immense enthusiasm in submitting my application for the Broadcast Associate role at CBS News. I am confident my skills, experiences, and accolades listed above and in my attached resume will bring value-added to your team. I can be contacted at (646) 592-7600 and Rivka.Cohen@mail.yu.edu. I look forward to discussing my candidacy.

Sincerely,

Rivka Cohen

